Interview Questions – Part B: Open-Ended Qualitative Questions (50 minutes)

Now, I would like to ask some questions to understand your experiences with buying and preparing food and using food assistance programs (such as SNAP or food stamps, food pantries, and school lunch programs) and how refugee organizations have helped you with food.

Questions on food and nutrition insecurity experiences and using food programs (40 minutes)

1. Tell me about your experience in buying and preparing food for your household in the U.S.

   I work and buy what I want

   Follow up: Can you explain more?

   I work and buy all the food that I want

   Follow up: Where do you buy food?

   At the market like Smiths

   Follow up: Do you have cooking appliances?

   Yes

   a. You indicated that you never had problems with food in the last 12 months. Research shows that many refugees experience food insecurity. Can you explain what things have helped you to have enough food for yourself and your family?

      I worked and bought all the food I wanted

   b. Can you explain how your <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> helped you with food?

      IRC helped us a lot. They gave food.

      Follow up: Did they give you money or a card for food.

      I think they gave us money

      Follow up: Did they teach you how to prepare meals? Yes

      Follow up: Did they teach you how to budget for the money? Yes

      Follow up: Did they teach you how to do grocery shopping? Yes

      Follow up: How did they do that?

      They showed us how to do it.

      Follow up: Did they teach you where you can get free meals? Yes

      Follow up: Did they teach you how to apply for SNAP? Yes

      i. What has been most useful to you among things that your <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> do?

         They gave me food

ii. You indicated that you have used SNAP program, can you tell me how you heard about this program and how you applied for it?

IRC taught me how to apply for it. I asked for it and applied for it

iii. Can you explain your experience with using this program?

I know how to apply for it by myself

iv. Tell me about the food you received from them. Tell me about your experience

I used to buy food, and they used to show you how much is left, and then I plan how I will manage.

v. What % of your foods come from this program?

100%

c. You indicated that in the last 12 months, you often/always worried that the food you were able to eat would hurt your health and well-being, can you tell me more?

Because the food here many times have side effects.

2. Tell me about your experience in finding and buying foods from your culture.
   a. How important eating foods from your culture is to you?

      It does not have bad side effects on my health

   b. Where do you get your vegetables and cultural foods from?

      In any store.

   c. How does/did <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> help you with finding foods from your culture?
      i. What did they do that was the most helpful and why?

         They showed me stores that have our cultural foods

   d. Do you use Farmers Market to buy foods from your culture?

      Yes

   e. Have you used the Sunnyvale Farmers Market (4013 S 700 W)?
      i. if yes, how did you hear about it and what has been your experience with that?

         Yes

         Follow-up: How did you know about it?

         IRC told me about it

   f. Can you describe your experience with the New Roots program (also known as IRC Garden or IRC Farm Program)?

      I don't have experiences in this program because I am just starting

      Follow up: So, you haven't started getting anything like food from this program?

      Yes. I am just starting

      i. Did this program give you more food to eat? please explain.

         I am just starting

      ii. Can you describe the training you received in this program?

They taught us how to grow food

iii. Can you explain whether and how this program has helped you in any ways?

No, I haven't seen anything because I am just starting out.

Suggestions for future strategies to improve food access (10 minutes)

This is the last section of our interview, and I would like to ask your suggestions on how to improve food security among refugees.

1. What do you think keeps people from your community from using food assistance programs that are available to them?

   Not knowing about the programs.

2. How do you think we can ensure that refugees can access food assistance programs when they need help with food?

   Making the application process easier. There's a way they ask for so many things which makes people not get that assistance because what is required is a lot.

3. What do you think <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY> and other refugee organizations can do to ensure refugees have enough food?

   Giving people gardens so we can grow our own food.

4. Do you want to share anything else regarding your experiences with food insecurity and using food assistance programs since you moved to the U.S. and since you graduated from <RESETTLEMENT AGENCY>?

   Nothing.